Day 57 (stop 1 of 3) - Cottonwood

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Sydenham section · hike 70 · Cottonwood Side Trail

2.1 km / 1.3 mi	~0.7 h	2.1 km new	146 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking along 11th Line at the entrance to the Cottonwood Side Trail. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day57a_hike070.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Cottonwood Side Trail (2.1 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 3 on day 57 (6.4 mi of hiking, about 321 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 71, 2.2 mi from Limited roadside parking is available about 450 m north of Hwy 26, where the main...; stop 3: hike 72, 2.9 mi from Roadside parking on the west side of 8th Concession N at the entrance to the Pines....

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside along 11th Line, north of Hwy 26, at the entrance to the Cottonwood Side Trail.
- **Cottonwood loop:** An easy 2 km loop and one of the few “satellite” side trails that do not connect to the Main Trail. It is named for a large, rare cottonwood tree along the way. The club walks it counter-clockwise.
- **Highlights:** A hidden waterfall and a lookout over Georgian Bay near the end of the loop.

- **Dogs:** The Sydenham club asks that dogs stay leashed and under control, especially on or near farmland, and suggests a bright orange harness or bandana during the fall hunting seasons.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking along 11th Line at the entrance to the Cottonwood Side Trail. Head east on the blue-blazed Cottonwood Side Trail.
2.1	1.3	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Sydenham Bruce Trail Club.